

CUAP E-CELL

IDEAS TO IMPACT. SKILLS TO SUCCESS.

ANNUAL REPORT 2026

THE ENTREPRENEURSHIP CELL

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF ANDHRA PRADESH

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About CUAP E Cell

The Entrepreneurship Cell of Central University of Andhra Pradesh (CUAP E-Cell) is a student-driven body dedicated to fostering a culture of innovation, enterprise and problem-solving on campus. Founded in 2026 as CUAP's official entry into the E-Cell IIT Bombay National Entrepreneurship Challenge (NEC 2026), the Cell exists to bridge academic learning and real-world entrepreneurial practice through workshops, mentorship, ideation challenges and industry interaction.

VISION

To build a thriving campus ecosystem where every student is empowered to think entrepreneurially, take initiative, and translate innovative ideas into impactful ventures that contribute meaningfully to society and the economy.

MISSION

- *Cultivate an entrepreneurial mindset among students through structured programs and mentorship.*
- *Provide a collaborative platform connecting students, mentors, investors and industry experts.*
- *Encourage interdisciplinary innovation by involving students from diverse academic backgrounds.*
- *Facilitate access to resources, networks and opportunities that support early-stage venture building.*

OBJECTIVES

- *Organize regular events, competitions and workshops centred on entrepreneurship and innovation.*
- *Represent Central University of Andhra Pradesh at national-level platforms such as NEC 2026.*
- *Build strong industry and alumni connections to support student ventures.*
- *Develop leadership, teamwork and problem-solving skills among student members.*
- *Create a sustainable, student-led organizational structure for long-term impact*

PURPOSE

CUAP E-Cell exists to serve as the nucleus of entrepreneurial activity within the university, nurturing ideas from conception to execution. By participating in NEC 2026, the Cell benchmarks its practices against leading student entrepreneurship bodies nationally while building a capable, well-structured team for future initiatives.

Message from the Faculty Advisor

Dear Students and Well-wishers,

It gives me great pleasure to see CUAP E-Cell grow into a vibrant platform for young innovators. This year, the team took part in the National Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026, hosted Eureka! 2026, and launched Launchpad to introduce first-year students to entrepreneurship.

What impressed me most was the initiative, discipline and teamwork shown by our students, who turned ideas into real events and experiences. I encourage every student, whatever their discipline, to join the E-Cell and learn by doing. My best wishes to the team for the journey ahead.



Sincerely,

P. Abhilash

Dr. Abhilash Ponnam,
Assistant Professor & Head (I/C),
Department of Management & Commerce

Message from the President

Dear Students, Mentors, and Well-wishers,

CUAP E-Cell started with a simple belief: our campus had no shortage of ideas, just a missing home for them. What began with just a few passionate students has grown into a recognized team of 13+ core members driven by purpose.

In our first year, we registered for NEC 2026, hosted Eureka! with 20 startup teams, ran the ₹100 Startup Challenge, held the "What Is The Problem?" ideation session, and launched Launchpad for first-years, all self-funded on a minimal budget.

More than events, I'm proudest of our people. Watching students shift from brainstorming to executing proves that consistency and trust matter far more than size. You don't need a business background to join us, just curiosity. The door is always open.



Sincerely,

Sumant Ghantewar
President & Strategy Lead, CUAP E-Cell

Organisational Structure & Core Team

CUAP E-Cell operates on a flat, collaborative hierarchy that ensures clarity of authority while promoting open communication across departments. The President provides overarching direction, supported by the Vice President & CTO who coordinates technology and cross-departmental alignment; six department heads then operate with functional autonomy across finance, technology, research, marketing, operations, and public relations.

Team Member	Role
Sumant Ghantewar	President & Strategy Lead
Avilash CJ	Vice President & Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
Nandu Prasad	Chief Financial Officer (CFO) & Head of Finance and Investment
S. Sanjay Kumar	Head of AI Research & Machine Learning
Jayanth Reddy Ragipindi	Head of Research, Data & Documentation
N Vamshi Krishna	Head of Marketing, Branding & People Operations
Sankepalli Nagatilak Datta	Head of Operations & Event Management
Aditya Raj	Head of Public Relations & Outreach

Why These Roles Were Assigned

Role assignments were made through a deliberate, holistic evaluation across eight parameters: leadership, technical expertise, communication skills, academic background, practical experience, teamwork, innovation and problem-solving ability. This ensured a merit-based and complementary structure in which every member's strengths directly serve the team's collective goals.

Year At A Glance – Events & Initiatives Timeline

1. **Head Start Task** — Section 5.1
   9 Aug 2026 · Core team activated under NEC 2026 with an icebreaker session and launch posts.
2. **Eureka! 2026 Business Pitching Competition** — Section 5.2
   25 Aug 2026 · Flagship contest with 20 startup teams and a four-member jury. Neptune G, a joint winner, advanced to the zonal rounds in Bengaluru.
3. **LinkedIn Presentation & Blog Series** — Section 5.3
   11 Sep 2026 · In-person personal-branding session, with the four-part blog series “The Entrepreneur’s Playbook.”
4. **₹100 Startup Challenge** — Section 5.4
   14 Sep 2026 · Instagram campaign where students pitched micro-businesses on a fixed ₹100 budget.
5. **“What Is The Problem?” Campus Ideation** — Section 5.5
   23 Sep 2026 · Open discussion on everyday campus problems that shortlisted five problem areas.
6. **Interact Within** — Section 5.6
   1 Oct 2026 · Peer-learning session on Google Meet with four fellow NEC teams.
7. **Freshers to Founders: Launchpad Phase 1** — Sections 5.7–5.8
   16 Oct 2026 · Intro session for first-year students and the Freshers Unfiltered video shoot.
8. **Build Week: Launchpad Phase 2** — Upcoming
   Nov 2026 (tentative) · Idea-to-startup workshops, mentoring and team formation.
9. **Pitch Finale: Launchpad Phase 3** — Upcoming
   Dec 2026 (tentative) · Teams pitch to a panel of founders, faculty and mentors.

5.1 Head Start Task – Team Formation & Outreach Launch

The Head Start Task marked CUAP E-Cell's official activation under NEC 2026. The eight-member core team met virtually for an icebreaker session to align on purpose, key messaging and outreach targets, before publishing a framed team photo and individual posts tagging @ecell_iitbombay.



The National Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026 poster featuring the icebreaker session.

5.2 Eureka! 2026 –Business Pitching Competition

Eureka! 2026 was CUAP E-Cell's flagship pitching competition, run in a strict two-minute pitch plus three-minute jury Q&A format across five stages: registration, jury introduction, twenty startup pitches, jury scoring, and a closing round of feedback, results and felicitation. Evaluation covered problem clarity, customer need, uniqueness, business model, feasibility, growth potential and overall startup potential.

Position	Startup	Team Leader
Joint 1st	Curie Core Energy Systems	Neptune G. R.
Joint 1st	Capital Link	Meda Sri Sai Subbaiah Harshith
2nd	Dwikavach	Bonthu Raj Dhanush

Beyond the top three, all 20 participating teams, spanning ideas from agri-tech and clean energy to campus services and consumer products, received structured jury feedback, and all four jury members were felicitated for their contribution.

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The images shown are from the Eureka 2026 Business Pitching Competition.

5.3 LinkedIn Presentation & Blog Series

To build the team's professional and digital-branding capability, CUAP E-Cell ran an in-person LinkedIn Presentation session covering personal branding, networking value, and how an E-Cell can build brand authority, partnerships and a talent pipeline through LinkedIn. This was paired with an ongoing blog series — "The Entrepreneur's Playbook" — published on the CUAP E-Cell LinkedIn page.

All eight core-team members also maintain individual LinkedIn profiles linked to the Cell, supporting a consistent professional identity for CUAP E-Cell across the network (full directory in the Annexure).







The images shown above are from the LinkedIn presentation.

5.4 ₹100 Startup Challenge – Social Media Campaign

The ₹100 Startup Challenge asked students to design a viable micro-business on a fixed ₹100 budget and pitch it in an Instagram Reel or Story tagging @cuap_e_cell. Entries ranged from a phone-cleaning desk and stencil rentals to plant-starter cups and exam flashcard packs, each with a costed spending plan and a projected surplus, judged on creativity (30%), feasibility within ₹100 (30%), pitch clarity (20%) and engagement/compliance (20%).







Glimpses from the ₹100 Startup Challenge session

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5.5 "What Is The Problem?" – Campus Ideation Discussion

This open group discussion asked participants to surface genuine, everyday campus problems and sketch venture-style solutions to each. Five problem areas were shortlisted for their entrepreneurial potential.

S.No.	Identified Problems	Suggested Solutions
1	**Inefficient garbage disposal and unmanaged organic waste**	Create a decentralized micro-composting system for hostel/canteen organic waste. Install source-segregation stations, assign student "green captains," and use simple QR/weight tracking to measure waste diverted. Compost can be used in campus landscaping or supplied to local nurseries, creating a small circular-economy venture.
2	**No organized reverse-logistics channel for dry recyclables**	Build a B2B reverse-logistics marketplace for paper, plastic, metal, e-waste and other dry recyclables. Aggregate material at scheduled collection points, record weight and category digitally, and connect verified recyclers/aggregators through transparent bids. Revenue or reward points can be shared with participating hostels/clubs.
3	**Limited confidential and timely mental-health support for students**	Create a peer-led support network with anonymous first-contact access, trained peer listeners and clear triage/referral pathways to qualified counsellors or health services. The platform should not diagnose or prescribe; it should focus on listening, awareness, appointment routing and emergency escalation when needed.
4	**Canteen food surplus and limited access to affordable meals at certain times**	Launch a campus surplus-food and smart-discount platform. Canteens can list safe, same-day surplus portions near closing time at reduced prices, while students receive availability alerts. Add demand forecasting and pre-ordering to reduce food waste, improve affordability and create a data-driven campus food enterprise.
5	**Students struggle to find verified short-term paid projects and practical experience**	Create a campus micro-internship and project marketplace linking students with faculty, university departments, startups, alumni and nearby MSMEs. Post short, outcome-based tasks with fixed timelines and transparent payment/recognition. Add skill profiles, mentor review and completion badges to build employability and entrepreneurial exposure.





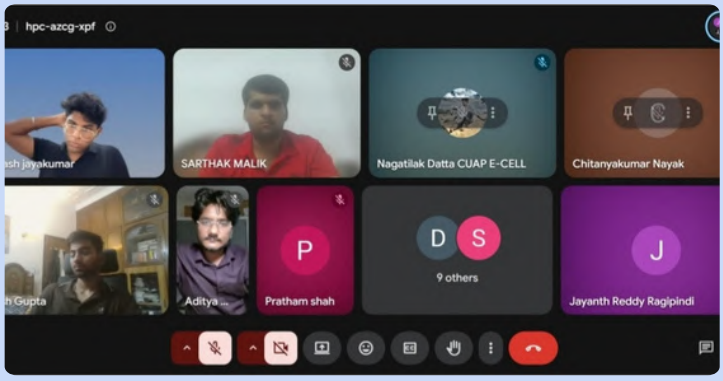
Participants during the campus ideation and discussion session

5.6 Interact Within

Team 1% (NEC2644385) of CUAP E-Cell joined a 50-minute NEC Interact Within session on Google Meet with four fellow NEC teams: GGSPIANS, NECessity, EIC SAKEC and Aryabytes. Teams shared their challenges, event planning approaches and future plans, and exchanged feedback on strengths and areas to improve. The session was a valuable peer-learning experience that gave us practical ideas to strengthen our own NEC activities.



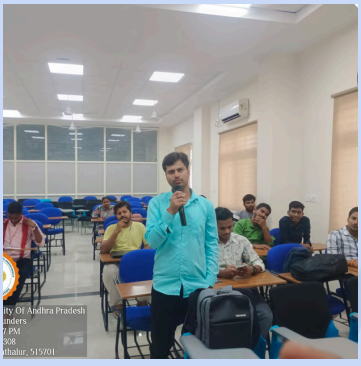




Screenshots from the NEC Interact Within session on Google Meet, 1 October 2026

5.7 Freshie Intro – Freshers to Founders

As part of Launchpad Phase 1, CUAP E-Cell produced "Freshers Unfiltered," a 10 to 15 minute intro video shot on the campus. First-year students were asked ten candid questions on entrepreneurship, startups and the E-Cell, and their funny, unfiltered answers were followed by clear formal explanations. The shoot was promoted through an Instagram invitation post with the NEC 2026 logo, tagging @iitbombay_ecell. The video introduced freshers to the E-Cell in an engaging way and invited them to join Launchpad.





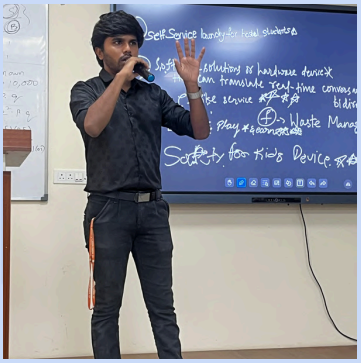


Moments from the Freshers Unfiltered shoot

5.8 Flagship Event – Launchpad

Launchpad is CUAP E-Cell's three-phase flagship programme that takes first-year students from their first idea to a real pitch. Phase 1, "Freshers to Founders," was held with five activities: Meet Your E-Cell, Freshers Unfiltered, the 10-Minute Start-up Challenge, a Start-up Quiz and an Idea Wall. It is followed by Phase 2, Build Week (idea-to-startup workshops and mentoring), and Phase 3, the Pitch Finale before a panel of founders, faculty and mentors. Open to students of all departments with no business background needed, Launchpad introduces freshers to entrepreneurship and builds an idea pipeline for the E-Cell.







Glimpses from Launchpad Phase 1, Freshers to Founders

Achievements & Milestones

- ***Registered and actively competing in the E-Cell IIT Bombay National Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026 (NEC ID: NEC2644385) and formed a team consisting of 8 members***



- ***Delivered Eureka! 2026, a flagship pitching competition with 20 participating startup teams and a four-member external-facing jury.***



- ***Ran a 20-entry, campus-wide ₹100 Startup Challenge on Instagram, with clear judging criteria and celebrated winners.***

- ***Facilitated a structured, campus-wide ideation discussion that shortlisted five venture-ready problem statements.***



- ***Published a 4-part LinkedIn blog series ("The Entrepreneur's Playbook") and conducted a dedicated LinkedIn personal-branding session for the team.***



Hosted "Freshers to Founders," Phase 1 of the Launchpad flagship event, on 16 October 2026 for first-year students across departments.



Prepared a complete Launchpad plan covering budget, sponsor outreach, publicity, venue and risk management.



Produced "Freshers Unfiltered," a 10 to 15 minute intro video where freshers answered ten candid entrepreneurship questions.



Joined the NEC Interact Within session with four fellow teams to share challenges, plans and feedback.

Neptune G, the Joint 1st of the Eureka 2026 Business Pitching conducted by CUAP E - Cell was selected for the zonal rounds of Eureka pitching where he pitched his idea infront of Corporate investors, held in Bengaluru.



Social Media And Digital Presence

CUAP E-Cell's launch post, the framed National Entrepreneurship Challenge team photo, was published across the E-Cell's own page and every core member's personal profile, each tagging @ecell_iitbombay and using the shared campaign hashtags. This was reinforced by individual "Know Your Team" introduction posts, event-day coverage of Eureka! 2026, and the ongoing LinkedIn blog series, giving the Cell a consistent presence across Instagram and LinkedIn from its very first week.

WE ARE ON

@cuap_e_cell

CUAP E CELL

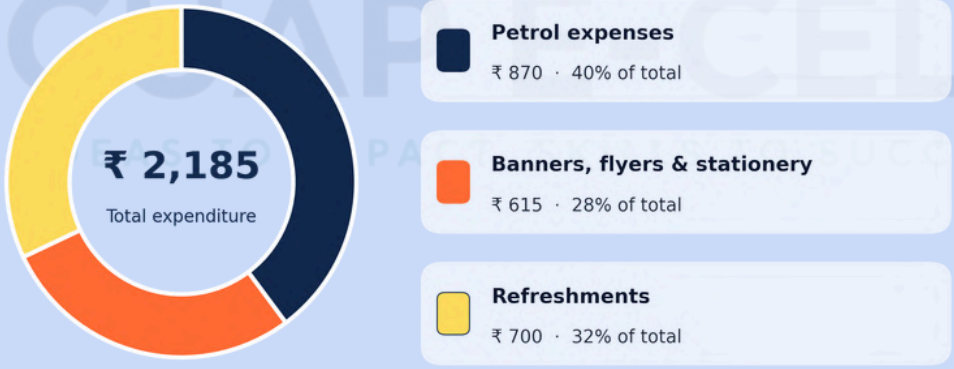
ecellstudents2026@gmail.com

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Financial Overview

CUAP E-Cell carried out its first year of activities on a very small budget. The expenditure below covers travel, publicity material and refreshments incurred while organising the events. It was met entirely by the team members, and the Cell received no income or external funding.

S.No.	Particulars	Amount (₹)
1	Petrol expenses	₹ 870
2	Banners, flyers & other stationery	₹ 615
3	Refreshments	₹ 700
	Total Expenditure	**₹ 2,185**
	Total Income	Nil
	Net Deficit (Income − Expenditure)	**₹ 2,185**



All expenditure this year went directly into event execution. As the Cell grows, it plans to move from self-funding to a structured model with university support, local sponsorships and in-kind partnerships. Upcoming Launchpad phases will follow transparent budgeting and a live expense record, with spending approved by the treasurer.

Voices of the Team

Ahead of NEC 2026, every core-team member recorded their individual motivation for joining CUAP E-Cell. A few excerpts:

"I am motivated to lead CUAP E-Cell because I want student ideas to move beyond conversation and become disciplined, visible outcomes."
*— **Sumant Ghantewar, President & Strategy Lead***

"Many campus initiatives depend on manual forms, scattered files and repeated follow-ups. I want to use technology as an enabling layer for registrations, communication and knowledge management."
*— **Avilash CJ, Vice President & CTO***

"A strong concept can fail when costs are unclear. I want students to see finance not as a barrier, but as a tool that helps them test feasibility and communicate credibility to mentors and sponsors."
*— **Nandu Prasad, Chief Financial Officer***

"I want to help students move beyond only talking about AI by building small prototypes that demonstrate usefulness in education, campus services and entrepreneurship."
*— **S Sanjay Kumar, Head of AI Research & Machine Learning***

"Sound entrepreneurial decisions begin with curiosity, evidence and clear documentation. My goal is to make research a practical decision tool for every department."
*— **Jayanth Reddy Ragipindi, Head of Research, Data & Documentation***

"Entrepreneurship grows when people can see an opportunity, understand it and feel invited to participate. I want our communication to build trust, not only visibility."
*— **N Vamshi Krishna, Head of Marketing, Branding & People Operations***

"Good ideas earn trust only when they are executed reliably. I want students to remember CUAP E-Cell activities as purposeful, well managed and respectful of their time."
*— **Sankepalli Nagatilak Datta, Head of Operations & Event Management***

"Opportunities create impact only when they reach the right people and are communicated with credibility. I want CUAP E-Cell to be visible as an open pathway for any student willing to learn."
*— **Aditya Raj, Head of Public Relations & Outreach***

Future Roadmap

The team's collective action plan for the year ahead centres on nine practical changes, each owned by the department closest to the outcome while other desks provide defined support:

#	Initiative	Focus
1	Strategic governance	Annual priorities, clear owners, short reviews and measurable outcomes
2	Digital infrastructure	A working website, registration systems, dashboards, automation and secure records
3	Financial discipline	Transparent budgets, sponsorship accounting, financial modelling and responsible spending
4	AI innovation	Problem-led AI/ML research, practical prototypes and responsible use
5	Evidence & documentation	Market research, clean data, impact reports and a searchable knowledge repository
6	Consistent brand & community	Year-round communication, clear campaigns, volunteer onboarding and engagement
7	Reliable event execution	Checklists, logistics plans, risk tracking, readiness reviews and post-event learning
8	Inclusive outreach	Department networks, student ambassadors and disciplined follow-up tracking
9	Partnership ecosystem	Structured corporate outreach, customised proposals, mentors and sponsors

Conclusion

In its first reporting cycle, CUAP E-Cell moved from an eight-member founding team to a structured, student-led organisation with defined roles, a clear vision and a consistent presence on Instagram and LinkedIn. Through the National Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026, the Cell activated its team, built an outreach identity and benchmarked its practices against peer E-Cells across the country, including through the Interact Within session with four fellow teams.

The year's activities reached students at every stage of the entrepreneurial journey. Eureka! 2026 gave twenty startup teams a real pitching platform before a four-member jury, and one of its winners, Neptune G, advanced to the zonal rounds in Bengaluru. The ₹100 Startup Challenge and the "What Is The Problem?" ideation discussion pushed students to think about viable businesses and everyday campus problems. The LinkedIn session and the Entrepreneur's Playbook blog series strengthened the team's professional presence. Launchpad, with its Freshers to Founders session and the Freshers Unfiltered video, brought first-year students into the E-Cell from their very first term.

Looking ahead, Build Week and the Pitch Finale will carry this momentum forward, turning ideas into teams and teams into ventures. We thank our faculty advisor, Dr. Abhilash Ponnam, the university for its support, E-Cell IIT Bombay for the NEC platform, and every student who took part. CUAP E-Cell remains committed to its motto,

*" **Ideas to Impact. Skills to Success**."*

Acknowledgements

CUAP E-Cell's first year was made possible by many people. We are grateful to each of them.

01 **Our Faculty Advisor**
Dr. Abhilash Ponnam, Assistant Professor & Head (I/C), Department of Management & Commerce, for his guidance, encouragement and belief in student-led initiative.

02 **Central University of Andhra Pradesh**
For the official permission and support that turned a small group of students into a recognised E-Cell.

03 **E-Cell IIT Bombay**
For the National Entrepreneurship Challenge 2026 platform, which gave us a purpose, a structure and a national community of peer teams.

04 **The Eureka! 2026 Jury**
All four jury members, for their time and for the structured feedback given to every one of the 20 participating teams.

05 **Participants and Students**
Everyone who pitched, joined a discussion, entered the ₹100 Startup Challenge or showed up as a first-year student at Launchpad.

06 **The CUAP E-Cell Team**
Every member, from the eight-member core team to the wider 13+ team, who gave their time, effort and personal funds to make each event happen.

ANNEXURE – Team Contact Directory

Team Member	Role	LinkedIn
Sumant Ghantewar	President & Strategy Lead	linkedin.com/in/sumant-ghantewar
Avilash CJ	Vice President & CTO	linkedin.com/in/avilash-jayakumar-835b8640b
Nandu Prasad	Chief Financial Officer	linkedin.com/in/m-nanduprasad
S. Sanjay Kumar	Head of AI Research & ML	linkedin.com/in/s-sanjay-kumar-67644724b
Jayanth Reddy Ragipindi	Head of Research, Data & Documentation	linkedin.com/in/jayanth-reddy-r
N Vamshi Krishna	Head of Marketing, Branding & People Ops	linkedin.com/in/vamshi-krishna-naspuri
Sankepalli Nagatilak Datta	Head of Operations & Event Management	linkedin.com/in/nagatilak-datta-64642334b
Aditya Raj	Head of Public Relations & Outreach	linkedin.com/in/aditya-raj-538a5b310

OUR TEAM



SUMANT GHANTEWAR
PRESIDENT



AVILASH CJ
VICE PRESIDENT & CTO



NANDU PRASAD
CFO



S SANJAY KUMAR
HEAD OF AI RESEARCH & MACHINE LEARNING



NAGATILAK DATTA
HEAD OF OPERATIONS & EVENT MANAGEMENT



N VAMSHI KRISHNA
HEAD OF MARKETING & BRANDING



JAYANTH REDDY RAGIPINDI
HEAD OF DATA, RESEARCH & DOCUMENTATION



ADITYA RAJ
HEAD OF PUBLIC RELATIONS & OUTREACH

EDITORIAL TEAM



NANDU PRASAD
Lead Editor



NAGATILAK DATTA
Lead Designer



RAGIPINDI JAYANTH REDDY
Project & Compliance Manager

2026

ecellstudents2026@gmail.com

Central University of Andhra Pradesh, Jnana Seema, Janthaluru, Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh